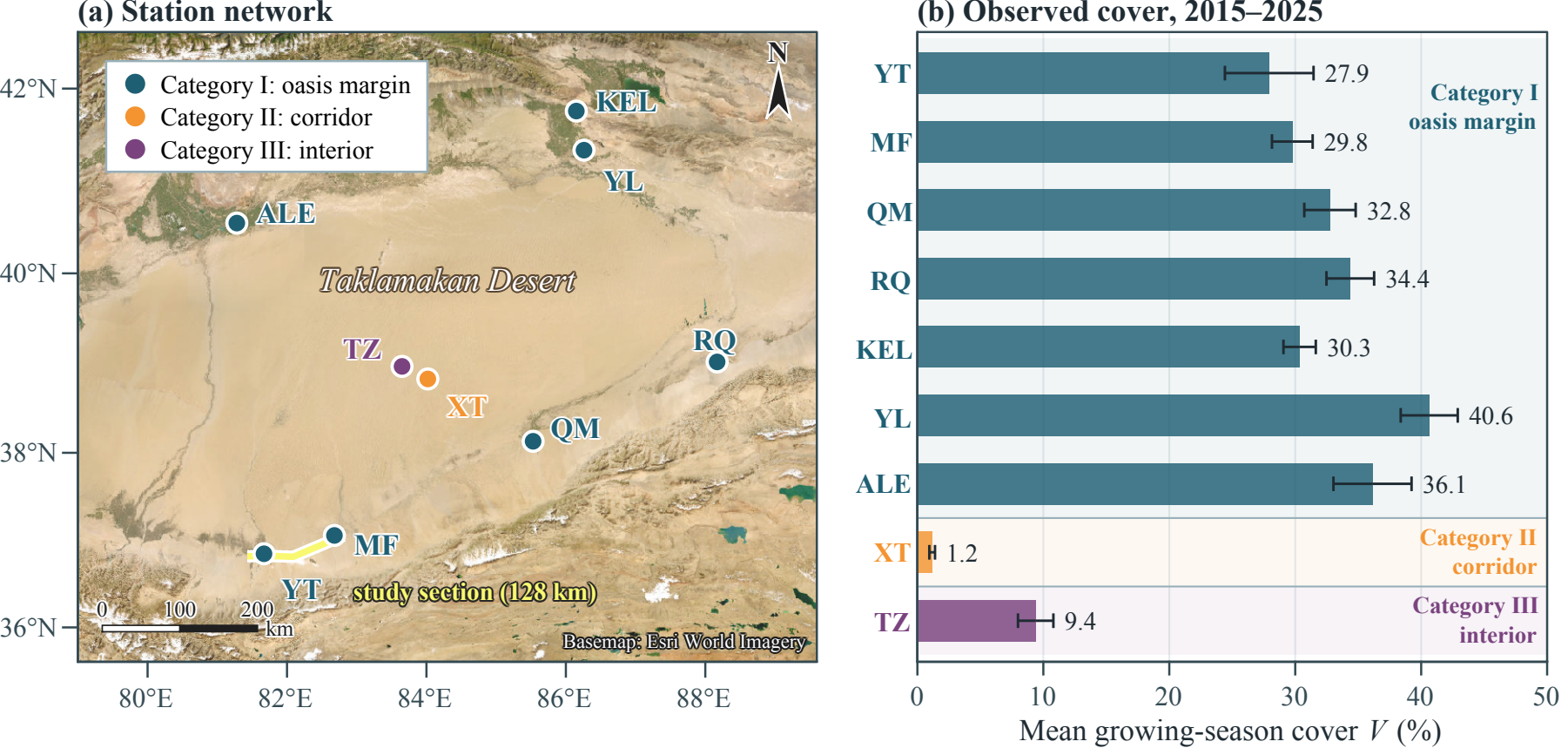

(a) Station network
Category I: oasis margin
Category II: corridor
Category III: interior
N
KEL
YL
ALE
Taklamakan Desert
TZ
RQ
XT
QM
MF
YT
study section (128 km)
0
100
200
km
Basemap: Esri World Imagery
42°N
40°N
38°N
36°N
80°E
82°E
84°E
86°E
88°E
(b) Observed cover, 2015–2025
YT
MF
QM
RQ
KEL
YL
ALE
XT
TZ
27.9
29.8
32.8
34.4
30.3
40.6
36.1
1.2
9.4
Category I
oasis margin
Category II
corridor
Category III
interior
0
10
20
30
40
50
Mean growing-season cover V (%)